

ACTIVITY 3 — LEARNER WORKSHEET**SIPOC, Process Mapping, Handoffs, and SME Support**

TYPE	DURATION	DMAIC PHASE
Core Activity	60 min	DEFINE

Name	
Date	

What you are doing

Build the macro 'as-is' view with SIPOC, then drill into a detailed process map that shows every actor, system and handoff — the points where delay and defects are actually created.

What you will produce: A completed SIPOC (5-7 steps), a swimlane process map with every handoff owned on both sides, and at least three tagged pain points.

Tools and techniques: SIPOC & Process Map Builder, process flowchart, swimlane map, standard process symbols

The scenario

Contoso Service Desk handles employee IT requests. Employees complain that tickets take too long to be assigned, that they must keep chasing for status, and that agents apply different definitions of what counts as "resolved". Handoffs between the front line and the specialist queues are unclear, and although ticket data exists it is inconsistent. You are supporting the improvement team as a Yellow Belt — you do not lead the project.

Two weeks of data have been collected: 400 tickets, of which 96 contained at least one defect, with 120 defects recorded in total across 6 defect opportunities per ticket. Mean assignment time is 55 minutes (median 46) against a 30-minute improvement goal. The CSV files in this activity's data/ folder are that extract.

Files in this activity folder**data/ — the mock data you analyse:**

- process-steps.csv — 7 rows (step_no, activity, actor, system, process_time_min, wait_time_min, handoff_to)

templates/ — the worksheets you complete:

- handoff-register.csv (handoff_no, from_actor, to_actor, trigger, owner_both_sides, pain_point)
- sipoc.csv (suppliers, inputs, process_step, outputs, customers)

Open these in Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice Calc. Work on a copy so the originals stay clean for revision.

data/process-steps.csv holds the as-is step, actor, system and timing data.

Your steps

1. Set the process boundaries — agree the explicit start and stop points first.
2. Build the SIPOC with the online builder: Suppliers, Inputs, Process (5-7 high-level steps), Outputs, Customers.

Tool: <https://alfredang.github.io/sipoc/>

3. Expand into a detailed process map: Step, Actor, Activity, System, Handoff.
4. Assign an actor to each step — the tool generates the swimlane and detects every handoff for you.
5. Tag pain points on the steps — waiting, rework loop, unclear ownership, duplicate entry or missing decision rule (at least three).
6. Prepare SME notes for the Green Belt: what you observed and what needs validation.

Your working space

Complete every field. Keep this worksheet — it is your reference for applying the method at work.

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Step 6 — Prepare SME notes for the Green Belt: what you observed and what needs validation.

Answers to the discussion prompts

1. Where exactly is the delay created — in a step, or in a handoff between steps?

2. Which handoff has no clear owner on one side, and what does that cause?

3. What did the process map show that the SIPOC could not?

Reflect & discuss

Map one handoff in your own process — who owns each side of it?

Where does work sit waiting in your process, and for how long?

Check your work

Run 'Check my SIPOC' in the tool — all five columns populated, 5-7 steps, at least three pain points, and every handoff owned on both sides.

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